

THE RIME OF THE
ANCIENT MARINER

Samuel Taylor Coleridge

PART I

It is an ancient Mariner,
And he stoppeth one of three.

'By thy long grey beard and glittering eye,
Now wherefore stopp'st thou me?

The Bridegroom's doors are opened

wide,

And I am next of kin;

The guests are met, the feast is
set:

May'st hear the merry din.'

He holds him with his skinny hand,

'There was a ship,' quoth he.

'Hold off! unhand me, grey-beard
loon!'

Eftsoons his hand dropt he.

He holds him with his glittering

eye—

The Wedding-Guest stood still,

And listens like a three years' child:

The Mariner hath his will.

The Wedding-Guest sat on a stone:

He cannot choose but hear;

And thus spake on that ancient
man,

The bright-eyed Mariner.

'The ship was cheered, the har-

bour cleared,

Merrily did we drop

Below the kirk, below the hill,

Below the lighthouse top.

The Sun came up upon the left,
Out of the sea came he!

And he shone bright, and on the
right

Went down into the sea.

Higher and higher every day,
Till over the mast at noon—'

The Wedding-Guest here beat his

breast,

For he heard the loud bassoon.

The bride hath paced into the hall,

Red as a rose is she;

Nodding their heads before her
goes

The merry minstrelsy.

The Wedding-Guest he beat his
breast,

Yet he cannot choose but hear;

And thus spake on that ancient

man,

The bright-eyed Mariner.

And now the STORM-BLAST came,

and he

Was tyrannous and strong:

He struck with his o’ertaking wings,

And chased us south along.

With sloping masts and dipping
prow,

As who pursued with yell and
blow

Still treads the shadow of his foe,
And forward bends his head,

The ship drove fast, loud roared
the blast,

And southward aye we fled.

And now there came both mist
and snow,

And it grew wondrous cold:

And ice, mast-high, came floating
by,

As green as emerald.

And through the drifts the snowy
clifts

Did send a dismal sheen:

Nor shapes of men nor beasts we
ken—

The ice was all between.

The ice was here, the ice was there,

The ice was all around:

It cracked and growled, and roared
and howled,

Like noises in a swound!